

PHILHEALTH CIRCULARNo. 2026-0011**TO : ALL SELF-PAYING MEMBERS, PHILHEALTH OFFICES,
AND ALL OTHERS CONCERNED****SUBJECT : Coverage of Self-Paying Members Under the Universal
Health Care (UHC) Act****I. RATIONALE**

Republic Act No. 11223, also known as the Universal Health Care (UHC) Act, establishes the fundamental right to health for all Filipino citizens by ensuring equitable access to quality, affordable healthcare while protecting individuals from financial risks. Integral to achieving this vision is the inclusion of self-paying members under the National Health Insurance Program (NHIP). As mandated by Section 5, Population Coverage, of the UHC Act, all Filipino citizens shall automatically be included in the Program, which is pivotal for promoting universal access to healthcare.

Self-paying members, which include, among others, self-earning individuals, professional practitioners, as well as Overseas Filipinos except seafarers and other sea-based workers, face significant challenges in obtaining adequate health coverage due to the absence of employer-provided insurance. These barriers can prevent them from accessing necessary healthcare services, leading to negative health outcomes. By extending coverage to these groups under the UHC framework, the Philippine Health Insurance Corporation (PhilHealth) can aid in meeting their healthcare needs, thereby closing critical gaps in the healthcare system and ensuring that they receive the support they deserve.

Furthermore, the inclusion of self-paying members reinforces the principles of equity and solidarity that underpin the UHC Act as they also benefit from comprehensive coverage, enhancing their overall well-being and promoting a more productive workforce. By recognizing and providing for direct contributors within the UHC framework, PhilHealth fosters a more inclusive healthcare system that dismantles barriers to essential services, thus ensuring that every Filipino can access quality care without incurring financial hardship.

II. OBJECTIVES

This PhilHealth Circular aims to provide guidance to self-paying members on aspects related to their registration under the NHIP and to their chosen primary care provider. Specifically, this PhilHealth Circular aims to apprise self-paying members in the registration process, updating of personal records, managing of premium accounts, and accessing of essential PhilHealth information. The overarching goal is to empower individuals to fully leverage their benefits and optimize their access to quality healthcare services.

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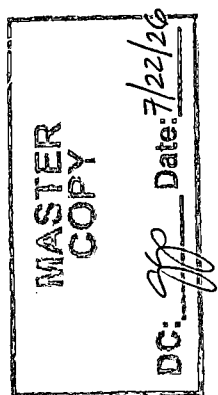
III. SCOPE

This PhilHealth Circular covers the registration, updating of member records, and management of premium accounts of self-paying members, as defined in Item IV.L of this policy.

IV. DEFINITION OF TERMS

- A. **Direct Contributors** – those who have the capacity to pay premiums, are gainfully employed and are bound by an employer-employee relationship, or are self-earning, professional practitioners, migrant workers including their qualified dependents, and lifetime members.
- B. **eGovPH App** – is the Philippines' official mobile application that provides a single, one-stop platform for accessing national and local government services.
- C. **Financially Capable** – a state where a person demonstrates clear capacity to pay for at least minimum prescribed rate for health insurance premium contributions in the NHIP or spend for necessary expenditures for one's medical treatment as assessed and certified by DSWD, medical social workers, social worker officers of the LGUs.
- D. **Financially Incapable (FI)** – individuals assessed by a licensed social worker from the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) or a local government unit (LGU) to have no capacity to pay the prescribed premium contributions in the NHIP.
- E. **Overseas Filipinos¹** – migrant workers (OFW), other Filipino nationals and their dependents abroad. Overseas Filipinos are comprised of the following:
 - 1. Land-based OFWs
 - 2. Seafarers and other sea-based workers
 - 3. Filipinos with dual citizenship (RA 9225)
 - 4. Filipinos living abroad
 - 5. Overseas Filipinos in distress
 - 6. Other overseas Filipinos not previously classified elsewhere
- F. **PhilHealth Identification Number (PIN)** – the permanent and unique number issued by the Corporation to individual members and to each and every dependent.
- G. **PhilHealth Member Portal** – a software tool that provides exclusive online access on membership and contribution services for individuals.
- H. **PhilHealth Member Registration Form (PMRF)** – the form used by the Corporation for the registration of new members or for updating or amendment of personal information of existing PhilHealth member.

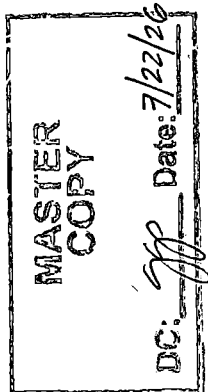
¹PC 2020-0014: Premium Contribution and Collection of Payment of Overseas Filipinos Members



- I. **Point of Service – Financially Incapable (POS-FI)** – members assessed as financially incapable by a medical social worker at the point of service or during admission to a health care facility.
- J. **Professional Practitioners** – include doctors, lawyers, certified public accountants, and other practitioners required to pass government licensure examinations in order to practice their professions.
- K. **Self-Earning Individuals** – those who render services or sell goods as a means of livelihood outside of an employer-employee relationship.
- L. **Self-Paying Members** – those who personally pay for their own premiums such as, but not limited to:
 - 1. Self-earning individuals
 - 2. Professional practitioners
 - 3. Overseas Filipinos except seafarers and other sea-based workers
- M. **Statement of Premium Account (SPA)** – a system-generated billing statement which indicates the reference number and total amount of premium due for the covered period including applicable interest and discounts. It is used to facilitate processing of payment.

V. POLICY STATEMENTS

- A. NHIP and Primary Care Provider Registration and Records Updating
 - 1. Self-paying members shall register, obtain a PhilHealth Identification Number (PIN), choose a preferred Primary Care Provider, and/or update their records through the following options:
 - a. Submission of properly filled-out PhilHealth Member Registration Form (PMRF) and/or Primary Care Selection Form (PCSF) (or any such revisions thereof), together with the required supporting documents, to any Local Health Insurance Office (LHIO), PhilHealth Express, or accredited registration partner.
 - b. Online access of the PhilHealth Member Portal directly through the link: <https://memberinquiry.philhealth.gov.ph/member/>
 - c. Mobile access of the eGovPH App of the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT).
 - 2. Upon registration into NHIP, all self-paying members shall be granted immediate eligibility to Program benefits.
 - 3. Self-paying members are required to maintain up-to-date records with PhilHealth, specifically their monthly income, contact information, and declared dependents. It is essential for members to promptly update these details whenever changes occur to ensure accurate and relevant information on file for the generation of the Statement of Premium Account (SPA) and Program benefits availment.

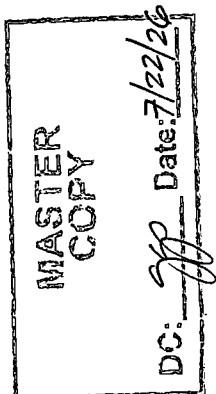


4. Any of the following documents may serve as acceptable proof of income:

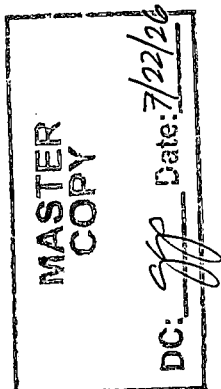
- a. For self-earning individuals and professional practitioners:
 - a.1. BIR-received Income Tax Return (ITR);
 - a.2. Income declared, attested and duly signed in the PhilHealth Membership Registration Form (PMRF) or in its electronic form or platform; or
 - a.3. Any documentary submissions as proof of income to be examined and validated, with utmost diligence, by the PhilHealth Regional Offices.
- b. For Overseas Filipinos, except for seafarers and other sea-based workers:
 - b.1. Employment Contract/ Certificate of Employment with Salary;
 - b.2. Payslips/Remittance Receipts;
 - b.3. BIR-received Income Tax Return (ITR);
 - b.4. Income declared, attested and duly signed in the PhilHealth Membership Registration Form (PMRF) or in its electronic form or platform; or
 - b.5. Any documentary submissions as proof of income to be examined and validated, with utmost diligence, by the PhilHealth Regional Offices.

B. Statement of Premium Account (SPA)

1. All self-paying members shall be required to present a SPA for any payment transactions conducted across all available payment channels. As such, payments will not be processed without an accompanying SPA. However, this requirement of SPA in all payment transactions shall exclude payments made in ACAs located in communities classified as Geographically Isolated and Disadvantaged Areas (GIDAs) as identified by the Department of Health (DOH).
2. The SPA for all unpaid applicable months from January 2026 onwards shall automatically be generated on the first day of each applicable month.
3. The SPA shall be made available to the member through his/her PhilHealth Member Portal account. The same SPA, or a notification thereof, shall also be sent to the member via the member's declared email address and/or contact number.
4. The SPA shall include relevant details such as:
 - a. PhilHealth premium due for the reflected applicable month/s;
 - b. Due Date of Payment
 - c. Payment instructions;
 - d. Provision on the accrual of interests on late payments; and
 - e. Notification on the unpaid applicable periods as self-paying member starting applicable month of January 2026 or from the date of registration to the NHIP, whichever comes later.



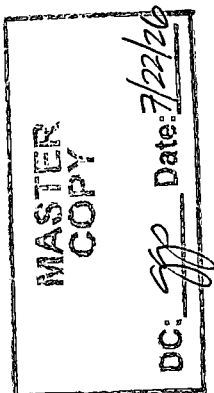
5. The guidelines on the handling of missed premium contributions for the applicable months prior to January 2026 shall be issued through a separate policy.
6. The computed applicable premium that will be reflected in the PhilHealth-generated SPA shall primarily be based from the last premium payment posted in the Contributions Database.
7. In instances where the declared income is not verifiable or not equal to the last premium payment posted in the Contributions Database, PhilHealth shall establish a clear verification and reconciliation process, requiring members to provide updated income documentation within a specified period to adjust future premiums and settle any arrears or overpayments. This process will ensure fairness and maintain the integrity of the Contributions Database.
8. In cases of absence of PhilHealth-generated SPA, or discrepancy of PhilHealth premium due, self-paying members may generate a new SPA reflecting the correct information through the PhilHealth Member Portal or the SPA generator, or request for the adjustment of SPA from any PhilHealth Office.
9. PhilHealth shall establish adequate facilities that enable members to conveniently access, view, generate and/or download their SPA such as SPA generator and PhilHealth Member Portal kiosks in accredited collecting agents, PhilHealth LHIOs and other areas deemed necessary by the PRO such as PhilHealth Express and Satellite Offices.
10. Representatives who are transacting in any PhilHealth Office on behalf of the member must present the following:
 - a. Authorization letter signed by the member;
 - b. One (1) valid government issued Identification Card (ID) with photo of the member; and
 - c. One (1) valid government issued Identification Card (ID) with photo of the representative.
11. Premium payments must match the amount indicated on the presented SPA.
12. Self-paying members may pay for any number of applicable months. However, all premiums for the calendar year must be settled no later than December 31 of that same year.
13. However, self-paying members shall further be allowed to settle all unpaid premiums for the preceding calendar year without incurring interest charges until January 31 of the year following the applicable contribution year, serving as a statutory one (1) month grace period.
14. Unpaid balances shall thereafter accrue interest per Section 9 of RA 11223, computed based from the actual due date which is December 31 of the applicable year.



15. Premium contributions can be remitted, upon presentation of the SPA, through any of the Local Health Insurance Offices (LHIOs) or Accredited Collecting Agents (ACAs) nationwide or abroad.
16. For easier and more convenient means, self-paying members may opt to pay using the PhilHealth Member Portal or other available online platforms.

C. Non-Payment and Program Benefits

1. Failure to pay premiums shall not prevent the enjoyment of any Program benefits. However, self-paying members shall be required to pay all missed contributions including its interest.
2. While the Universal Health Care Act grants immediate eligibility for benefits upon enrolment, it is crucial for all self-paying members to understand and fulfill their continuous obligation to pay the required premiums. As such, failure to pay in full the applicable premiums on or before the one-month grace period will constitute delay and any outstanding balance on the annual premium contributions for the prior year shall be subject to interest, compounded monthly, not exceeding one and one-half percent (1.5%) consistent to Section 9 of the UHC Act. Failure to settle contributions, including any missed payments and applicable interest or penalties, will result in consequences as outlined in Section V.C.6 of this Circular and Section 38.10 of the UHC Act's Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR).
3. On the other hand, in cases of inability to pay, the member shall be referred to the social worker of the DSWD or the concerned LGU where the member resides, the medical social worker or any licensed social worker to undergo an assessment of financial capacity.
4. Individuals who are assessed to have no capacity to pay the prescribed premiums shall submit a case study, a certificate of indigency or financial incapacity, or any other similar document issued by licensed social workers to PhilHealth to be classified as Point of Service – Financially Incapable (POS-FI) or Indirect Contributors – Financially Incapable (FI), whichever is applicable.
5. A member with an outstanding balance from November 2019 onwards or who has been unable to pay premium contributions for multiple years but can provide the supporting document/s mentioned above, will be granted automatic exemption from paying premium contributions for the current applicable month and all outstanding contributions from previous periods.
6. Members who fail to settle their missed premium contributions within the grace period may face imposition of interests. However, if member commits intentional violation such as fraud or collusion to defraud the Program, he/she may face potential suspension of entitlement to Program benefits after due process or other consequences in accordance with the UHC Act, its IRR and pertinent guidelines.



D. Monitoring and Evaluation

1. This policy will undergo periodic reviews and evaluations to assess its impact, relevance, and effectiveness in meeting the goals of providing healthcare coverage to self-paying members. Evaluation metrics will be defined to measure the policy's outcomes, identify any gaps or areas for improvement, and ensure its continued alignment with the objectives of the Universal Health Care Act.
2. A robust data collection and analysis system will be implemented to track key performance indicators, such as registration rates, premium payment compliance, healthcare utilization patterns, and beneficiary satisfaction levels. This data will be used to monitor trends, identify disparities, and generate insights to inform policy adjustments and strategic decision-making.

E. Confidentiality Clause

PhilHealth is dedicated to protecting the privacy and confidentiality of its members' data. To ensure data security, all partner stakeholders with access to sensitive information must sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA). This agreement safeguards members' personal information from loss, misuse, unauthorized access, and other activities that could compromise security and confidentiality.

VI. PENALTY CLAUSE

Any violation of this PhilHealth Circular and all related issuances will be subject to penalties in accordance with Republic Act No. 11223, otherwise known as the Universal Health Care Act, along with its Implementing Rules and Regulations, and other relevant laws, rules and regulations.

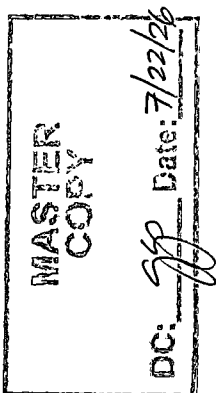
VII. SEPARABILITY CLAUSE

If any provisions of this PhilHealth Circular are declared unconstitutional or invalid by a court of law or competent authority, the remaining provisions shall continue to be in full force and effect.

VIII. TRANSITORY CLAUSE

To ensure an orderly, equitable, and system-ready implementation of the mandatory SPA requirement for premium payment transactions, the following implementation phases are hereby adopted:

1. Transition Period: January 1, 2026 to December 31, 2026
 - a. The use of the SPA shall be enforced as the standard and preferred mechanism for premium billing and payment of self-paying members.



- b. During this transition period, PhilHealth shall adopt a calibrated and facilitative approach to implementation, allowing limited, documented flexibility in the acceptance of payments without SPA under the following circumstances:

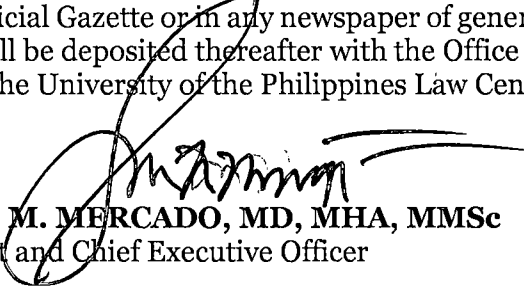
- b.1. First-time SPA users encountering system or record-related constraints;
- b.2. Members with pending verification or updating of income or membership records;
- b.3. Temporary unavailability of SPA-related systems.

2. Full Implementation: Effective January 1, 2027

- a. The presentation of a valid SPA shall become a strict and non-negotiable requirement for all premium payment transactions of self-paying members across all channels, except for those expressly exempted by law or policy (e.g., GIDAs).
- b. Acceptance of payments without SPA outside of authorized system downtime shall no longer be allowed.

IX. DATE OF EFFECTIVITY

This PhilHealth Circular shall take effect fifteen (15) days after publication in the Official Gazette or in any newspaper of general circulation. Three (3) certified copies shall be deposited thereafter with the Office of the National Administrative Register of the University of the Philippines Law Center.


EDWIN M. MERCADO, MD, MHA, MMSc
President and Chief Executive Officer

Date signed: 07/22/2026

Coverage of Self-Paying Members Under the Universal Health Care Act

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